



MONTHLY UPDATE

Botswana: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-06 · 10 systems and instruments tracked, 11 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-06 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

The data-protection commission issued a [determination and enforcement notice against the public service management directorate on 17 July 2026](#), taking the government payroll portal offline. It is the first published enforcement against a government body, and the portal has no reopening date.

The public accounts committee was told on 30 July that the [national public key infrastructure is funded, begun, incomplete and non-operational](#): P423m secured, control transferred to the intelligence directorate, no working system, no timeline and no accountable owner.

A parliamentary answer of 28 July attributed identity-card delays to [too few production staff and ageing equipment with frequent breakdowns](#), running since the start of 2026 with no backlog figure and no restoration date.

Two instruments were made rather than reported on: a [national e-waste management strategy launched with an inter-agency memorandum on 13 July](#), carrying no targets or budget, and the [first phase of a regional fibre corridor carrying traffic from 6 July](#).

Infrastructure

The [Plumtree-Bulawayo section of a regional fibre corridor went live on 6 July, carrying traffic at 800Gbps equipped on equipment rated over 10Tbps](#), with a second phase to Livingstone due September 2026. The corridor is stated as a Botswana-Zimbabwe-Zambia route; the live section is inside Zimbabwe and no Botswana segment is dated.

Digital public infrastructure

Three identity and registry items moved, and two of them are failures of capacity rather than of design.

The public accounts committee was told on 30 July that the [national public key infrastructure has P423m secured, control transferred to the intelligence directorate, and no working system, timeline or accountable owner](#). On the committee's account Botswana has no certificate-backed identity verification and no recognised electronic-signature layer. The ministry's own headline figure appears as both P420m and P423m in the single account.

On 28 July a parliamentary answer put identity-card replacement delays down to [too few production staff and ageing equipment with frequent breakdowns](#). The delays have run since the start of 2026 and the answer carries no backlog figure, no restoration date and no equipment-replacement commitment.

Against those, two systems entered service or testing. The electoral commission's [elections management system is built and under extensive testing, replacing platforms developed in the 1990s, for deployment at the 2029 general election](#); no supplier, cost or acceptance date is held, and the commission's secretary separately states as personal opinion that Batswana do not want electronic voting machines. In the week of 13 July an [animal disease surveillance dashboard was launched, integrating the traceability system with district veterinary networks](#); the source is a paywalled lede and no coverage or user figure is held.

The government payroll portal was [taken offline on 22 July, with a privacy notice, an impact assessment, multi-factor authentication and disaster recovery added](#) and no reopening date stated.

Governance and regulation

The data-protection commission [issued a determination and enforcement notice against the public service management directorate on 17 July, with compliance evidence due within one month](#). The directorate published a privacy notice on 6 July and completed an impact assessment on 13 July; the determination itself is not held, and both accounts of it are press carries.

It is the commission's second enforcement action on record, after non-bank financial institutions in February 2026, and its first against a government body. A year earlier the commission ran on [three contract officers with no premises, no published address, no website and no deputy commissioner](#); it still has no budget organisation or line of its own.

On 13 July the regulator and the environment department [launched a national e-waste management strategy and signed an inter-agency memorandum](#). No targets, budget, collection volumes or implementation dates were published, and the strategy document itself is not on file.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

No artificial-intelligence or technology-sector row moved in this window.

Inclusion, capacity and finance

Two school digital centres were handed over in the North West District on 22 and 23 July, at [P1.45m and P1.5m per site with thirty machines each](#). They are financed by the universal access and service fund, which draws a 1% levy on mobile service providers; no programme total, annual allocation or school target has been published, and the per-site cost remains the only figure on the record. The base carried nothing on the fund's school programme before January 2026, so the two handovers are the whole of what is known about its delivery.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.